

Prompt Selection

Should universities require mandatory disclosure of ALL AI use that substantively shaped a student assignment's content or argument?

Outline

Opening Sentence	Not all AI use used in support of a student's assignment needs to be disclosed.
Evidence Block 1	Arguing that students need to document any and all AI usage in assignment completion is based in concerns about automation, namely that AI might be used to replace human thought or action (Noy & Zhang, 2023). However, as Noy and Zhang (2023) also pointed out, automation can also serve to complement human effort.
Evidence Block 2	Recent research (Hardy et al., 2026) has suggested that students primarily use GenAI tools for tasks such as brainstorming and outlining rather than simply asking for papers to be written for them. This would suggest that students are generally being judicious in how they incorporate AI into their writing process.
Strongest Counterargument	Critics might argue that instructors need not only final products from students, but evidence of their learning process as well, as learning is not just about final products.
Rebuttal	However, this was not true in the past. If a student sought help from friends, tutors, or the campus writing center, this did not require documentation, and ultimately GenAI is not so different from working with people. Although documenting the learning process can be a good idea, if we didn't consider it necessary in the past, we should consider if the current situation is so different that it merits a different approach.
Closing Sentence	Ultimately, we need to give students the latitude to make wise decisions. This doesn't mean no oversight, but it also does not mean going overboard to ensure they do things exactly as we wish.

Position Paper

Not all AI used in support of student assignments needs to be disclosed. Arguing that students need to document any and all AI usage in assignment completion is based in concerns about automation, namely that AI might be used to replace human thought or action (Noy & Zhang, 2023). However, as Noy and Zhang (2023) also pointed out, automation can also serve to complement human effort, so automation is not the guaranteed result of AI use. Recent research (Hardy et al., 2026) has suggested that students primarily use GenAI tools for tasks such as brainstorming and outlining rather than simply asking for papers to be written for them. This would suggest that students are generally being judicious in how they incorporate AI into their writing process, seeking ways that it can complement, rather than replace them. Critics might argue that instructors need not only final products from students, but evidence of their learning process as well, since learning is not just about final products. However, this was not true in the past. If a student sought help from friends, tutors, or the campus writing center, this did not require documentation, and getting help from GenAI is not so different from getting help from people. Although documenting the learning process can be a good idea, if we didn't think it was necessary in the past, we should consider if the current situation is so different that it merits a different approach. Ultimately, we need to give students the latitude to make wise decisions. This doesn't mean no oversight, but it also does not mean that we should be micromanaging their learning processes.